

DAMASCUS, Syria (AP)

— The Syrian government hanged three pro-Palestinian guerrillas at dawn today in swift retribution for a bloody raid on a Damascus hotel just 24 hours earlier.

A fourth guerrilla and four hostages were killed

and 34 hostages were wounded in a seven-hour battle for the Semiramis Hotel in the most daring Palestinian attack yet in Syria.

The three surviving terrorists were hanged in a public square facing the luxury hotel. Their bodies,

clad only in white tunics, were left dangling in nooses for six hours as thousands of Syrians pressed around the gallows and climbed to balconies and rooftops to see the victims

The guerrillas called themselves the 'Black June'' group and apparently were protesting Syria's military intervention that began last June in the Lebanese civil war

Before they were executed, the three went on Syrian state television and said they belonged to Al Fatah, the biggest Palestinian guerrilla group. They also said they had been trained in Iraq, which has supported

radical Arab organizations and has denounced the Syrian role in Lebanon.

But in. Beirut, a spokesman for the Palestine Liberation Organization (PLO), the Palestinian umbrella group headed by Yasir Arafat, denied that any PLO members' were responsible. Arafat also heads Al Fatah, which is considered to be less radical than some Palestinian guerrilla units.

A Syrian government statement said the four hostages who died Sunday were killed by the terrorists. Three of the slain hostages were women, and witnesses said all were Arabs. Three Americans were reported in the hotel at the time and one, National Broadcasting Corp. assistant producer Robert Castenbach, was taken hostage but was unharmed, the US. Embassy said.

According to an account pieced together from witnesses and security officers, the four-member team pulled up to the hotel at about 5 a.m. Sunday in a dark blue car with Lebanese license plates. They asked for a room, were told none was available, left and returned with submachine guns and grenades.

Security officers said the commandos moved from floor to floor of the five-

story hotel rousing guests
from their sleep and taking
them captive. Someone
called police and the hotel
was immediately
surrounded, witnesses
said.

Security forces cut off
communications to the

hotel and the guerrillas,
holding the to op oor,
opened fire a

grenades down on eas
Syrians.